

SENATE BILL 1568

By Roberts

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15,
Chapter 2, relative to Clog Dancing Day.

WHEREAS, clog dancing is a vibrant and enduring American folk-art form that draws from the rich traditions of European, African, and Native American cultures, and continues to thrive in communities across the nation, particularly in the Appalachian region of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee holds a special place in the cultural story of clog dancing, where it has been nurtured for generations as both an expressive art form and a cherished social activity, often featured at festivals, community events, and family gatherings; and

WHEREAS, the rich musical traditions of Tennessee—especially bluegrass, folk, and old-time music—provide a perfect companion to clog dancing, and the dance form has been celebrated on iconic stages such as the Grand Ole Opry, where cloggers have performed alongside legendary country musicians, elevating the art to national and international acclaim; and

WHEREAS, clog dancing continues to be passed down through local studios, schools, and youth programs, encouraging community engagement and artistic development for dancers of all ages and backgrounds, while also strengthening Tennessee's tourism and cultural heritage economy through major events and festivals; and

WHEREAS, William "Bill" Nichols, the "grandfather of modern clog dancing," significantly advanced the art form in both recreational and competitive spheres. Therefore, August 8, the anniversary of his passing, is an appropriate date to promote American clog dancing and inspire everyone to engage in its joyful exercise; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the State of Tennessee honor the dancers, teachers, and organizations who have preserved, performed, and advanced this uniquely American art form, recognizing clog dancing as a meaningful expression of Tennessee's cultural identity and heritage; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15, Chapter 2, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

August 8 of each year is observed as "Clog Dancing Day in the Volunteer State" to recognize the cultural, educational, and artistic contributions of clog dancing to this state and nation, and to encourage all Tennesseans to celebrate the history, musicality, and community spirit of this cherished Appalachian tradition.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.